

value products, they not only have to make them available, but they also had to make them more accessible. This thought gave rise to the various EMI schemes available all over the e-retail landscape.

More recently, both the major online retailers have introduced EMI schemes based on debit cards as well. These are subject to pre-approval from the debit card provider and is usually slightly different in conditions from EMI based on credit cards.

Today, online retailers like Flipkart, Amazon and Snapdeal not only provide a discount on discounts, they even provide options to pay these discounted prices in instalments. The huge demand for such schemes impressed banks and Non-Banking Financial Companies (NBFCs) as well, and soon they jumped in on the wagon. Online retailers built relationships with most large-scale banks to provide EMI schemes based on their credit cards. Changing with the tides, banks came up with more schemes, special cards, and online platforms to facilitate easier purchases. Axis Bank is one forerunner in this sector with special credit cards aimed especially at online shopping.



EMI on Debit Card promotion by Flipkart.com

NBFCs and micro-lending firms cropped up in plentiful offering EMI cards and no cost EMI schemes all over. Partnering with online retailers, they provided pre-approved credit limits, EMI cards and other previously mind-blowing offers without much in the form of guarantees or collateral. They all place themselves strategically as alternatives to the credit card. The front-runner in this marathon would be the Bajaj Finserv EMI online store. They partnered with a wide variety of retailers, both online and offline, to facilitate faster online shopping on a monthly instalment basis. They also introduced pre-approved EMI cards that allowed customers to make pay-